



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: June 4, 2026	Entry: 1
Description	A small U.S. healthcare clinic experienced a ransomware attack, in which attackers gained access to the internal network through phishing emails. Employees reported that they were unable to access patient data on their computers. As a result, the organization had to shut down its computer systems to resolve the issue.
Tool(s) used	None.
The 5 W's	• Who: An organized group of unethical hackers. • What: A ransomware security incident. • When: 9:00 AM on Tuesday. • Where: At a health care clinic. • Why: The incident happened when attackers successfully gained access to the company's network by sending phishing emails with malicious attachments to employees. Once the attachment was downloaded, the ransomware was deployed to encrypt critical files. The motivation is likely financial, as the attackers demanded a large sum of money in exchange for the decryption key of encrypted files.

Additional notes	1. The company should establish an IT department to monitor and respond to security incidents using cybersecurity tools. 2. All employees need attending mandatory training to identify and respond to cybersecurity risks. 3. The company needs to analyze this incident by applying the NIST CSF framework.
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